



JobTrail

User guide · version 1.5

A Chrome extension that helps you grow your network, apply for jobs and keep track of it all on LinkedIn.

JobTrail is independent and is not affiliated with or endorsed by LinkedIn.

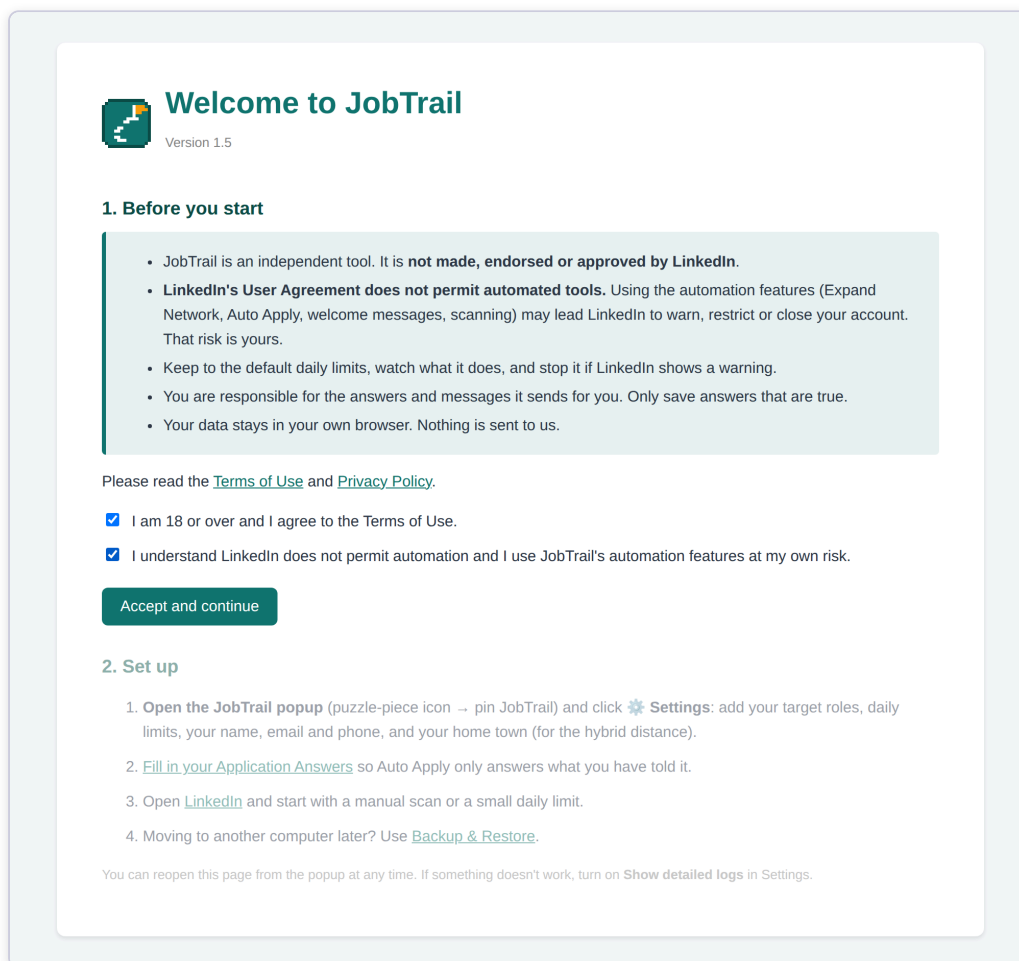
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All screenshots show example data. Everything the extension stores stays in your own browser; nothing is sent to any server.

1. Installing the extension

1. Unzip the download to a folder you'll keep, for example `Documents\jobtrail`. Don't delete this folder afterwards; Chrome runs the extension from it.
2. In Chrome, go to `chrome://extensions`.
3. Turn on **Developer mode** (top-right switch).
4. Click **Load unpacked** and choose the unzipped folder (the one containing `manifest.json`).
5. Click the puzzle-piece icon in Chrome's toolbar and pin **JobTrail** so it's always visible.
6. A **Welcome to JobTrail** page opens. Read the summary, the Terms of Use and the Privacy Policy, tick both boxes and click **Accept and continue**. Until you do, the automation buttons in the popup are greyed out.
7. Open `linkedin.com` and sign in. A small dot appears in the top-right corner of LinkedIn: the extension is active.



The welcome page on first install (reopen it any time from *Getting started* at the bottom of the popup)

Updating: replace the folder's contents with the new version, then click the ↺ refresh icon on the extension in `chrome://extensions` and reload LinkedIn. Your settings and history are kept.

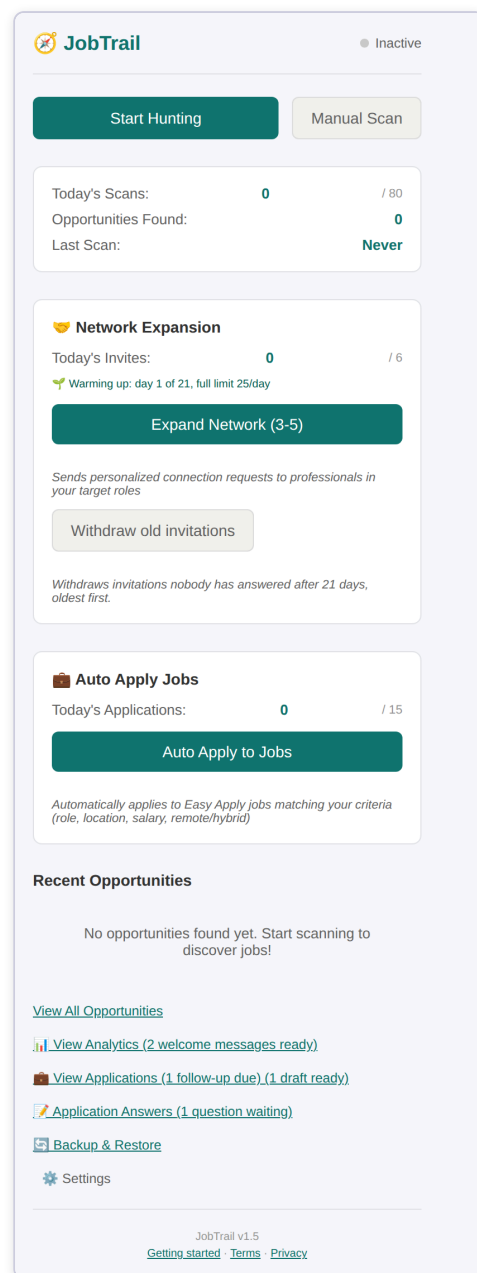
2. The popup and first-time settings

Click the extension icon while on LinkedIn to open the popup. From here you can:

- **Expand Network:** send personalised connection requests (section 4).
- **Auto Apply to Jobs:** apply to Easy Apply jobs matching your criteria (section 5).
- Open the other pages: **Analytics**, **Applications**, **Application Answers** and **Backup & Restore**.

The links show reminders in brackets, for example *(1 follow-up due)* or *(1 question waiting)*.

Start Hunting and **Manual Scan** look through your LinkedIn feed for hiring posts and list them under *Recent Opportunities*.



The popup

Settings (click ⚙ Settings at the bottom of the popup)

Setting	What it does
Target Roles	Job titles of the people Expand Network searches for (e.g. <i>IT Manager</i> , <i>Security Engineer</i>).
Max Daily Connection Requests	Hard daily cap on invitations. Keep to 20–30.
Connections Per Role	How many invites to send for one role before moving to the next.
Use Personalised Messages	Adds a short personal note to each invite.

Warm up gradually	On by default. Starts at a quarter of your daily limit and builds up to it over 3 weeks. Untick and tick again to restart after a break.
View each profile before inviting	On by default. Opens the person's profile in a background tab for a few seconds before inviting them.
Withdraw invitations older than (days)	Used by Withdraw old invitations (default 21).
Do not contact	Names, companies or profile links never to invite or message, one per line.
Only Connect with People Actively Hiring	Uses LinkedIn's "Hiring" filter and hiring-focused wording.
Max Daily Applications	Daily cap for Auto Apply.
Target Job Roles	The job titles Auto Apply searches for and must match.
Minimum / Maximum Salary	Skips jobs whose listed salary is outside this range.
Work Types	Remote / Hybrid / On-site jobs to apply for.
Hybrid (within the distance below), Home town, Max distance	Hybrid jobs further than this many miles from your home town are skipped. Type a UK town or city; a ✓ shows it was recognised.
Full Name, Email, Phone	Used to fill in the contact details on application forms.
Daily Profile Limit, Delays, Keywords	Feed scanning: how much to scan and which words mark a hiring post.
Show detailed logs	Off normally. Turn on only when troubleshooting (see section 10).

Click **Save Settings** when you're done.

2. Settings panel (full view)

Settings

Daily Profile Limit:

Maximum profiles to scan per day (1-200)

Min Delay (seconds):

Max Delay (seconds):

Job Keywords (comma-separated):

Target Roles (comma-separated):

Network Expansion Settings

Max Daily Connection Requests:

Recommended: 25-30/day (LinkedIn allows ~100/week)

Connections Per Role (per search):

How many connections to send before switching to next role (1-10)

☒ Use Personalized Messages
Adds custom notes to connection requests (more natural)

☒ Warm up gradually
Starts at a quarter of your daily limit and builds up to it over 3 weeks. Recommended for new accounts or after a break; untick and tick again to restart.

☒ View each profile before inviting
Opens their profile in a background tab for a few seconds first (they'll see you viewed it). Counts towards 60 profile views a day.

Withdraw invitations older than (days):

Used by "Withdraw old invitations"

Do not contact (one per line):

Names, companies or profile links never to invite. People you've invited before are always skipped.

Want to compare two invitation wordings? Set up a [message test](#) on the Analytics page.

[test](#) on the Analytics page:

☐ Only Connect with People Actively Hiring
Uses LinkedIn's "Hiring" filter to target recruiters and hiring managers posting jobs

☐ Show detailed logs (for troubleshooting)
Writes step-by-step progress to the browser console (F12 → Console) on LinkedIn pages

Job Application Settings

Max Daily Applications:

Maximum job applications per day (1-50, recommended: 20)

Target Job Roles (comma-separated):

Job titles to search for

Minimum Salary (£):

Leave empty for no minimum

Maximum Salary (£):

Leave empty for no maximum

Work Types:

☒ Remote

☒ Hybrid (within the distance below)

☐ On-site

Select which work types to apply for

Your Home Town:

✓ Found Maidstone

Max Distance for Hybrid Jobs (miles):

Your Full Name:

For auto-filling application forms

Your Email:

For auto-filling application forms

Your Phone:

For auto-filling application forms

Save SettingsReset to Defaults

Settings, opened from the bottom of the popup (continues in the right-hand column)

3. Application Answers

Easy Apply forms ask questions such as "*Are you legally authorised to work in the UK?*" or "*How many years of experience do you have with Linux?*". Fill these answers in once and Auto Apply uses them for every application.

- **Right to work & working arrangements:** Yes / No / Not set. *Not set* means "ask me".
- **Security clearance:** the level you hold and whether you're willing to be vetted.
- **Experience:** total years, certifications and years per skill. Add one row per skill; add alternative names as separate rows (e.g. *Azure AD* and *Entra ID*).
- **Salary & notice, education, English level, links.**
- **Your own answers:** "if the question contains *how did you hear*, answer *LinkedIn*".

Nothing is guessed. If a question has no saved answer, the application is saved as a draft and the question appears in **Questions waiting for an answer** at the top of this page. Answer it once and future applications fill it in. Use **Try a question** at the bottom to check what would be answered.

Application Answers

Auto Apply fills in Easy Apply questions from these answers. Anything left blank or "Not set" is left for you: the application is saved as a draft and the question appears below to answer once.

✔ Drafts ready to complete

Your saved answers now cover every question that stopped 1 draft application (Information Security Officer). JobTrail can reopen each job on LinkedIn and submit it with these answers, one at a time.

[Complete them now](#)

[See them on the Applications page](#)

? Questions waiting for an answer 1

These stopped an application. Answer each one once and future applications will fill it in.

How many years of experience do you have with Splunk?
Seen 1 time - last in GRC Analyst at Northbank plc

Number

[Save](#)

[Dismiss](#)

Right to work & working arrangements

Legally allowed to work in the UK

Yes

Need visa sponsorship (now or in future)

No

Hold a full UK driving licence

Yes

Happy to commute to the job's location

Yes

Willing to relocate

Not set (ask me)

Comfortable working remotely

Yes

Comfortable working hybrid

Comfortable working on-site / in the office

Willing to undergo background checks (DBS,

[Save answers](#)

Have unspent criminal convictions

Not set (ask me)

Need reasonable adjustments for interviews

Not set (ask me)

Security clearance

Clearance you currently hold

SC

Eligible and willing to undergo clearance

Yes

Experience

Total years of work experience

12

Certifications you hold (comma separated)

ISO 27001 Lead Implementer, CISSP

Years of experience by skill

Used for "How many years of experience do you have with ...?" and "Do you have experience with ...?". A skill that isn't listed is left for you rather than guessed.

Skill or technology

Years

ISO 27001

10

×

Linux

8

×

Azure

6

×

[+ Add skill](#)

Salary & notice

Salary expectation (£ per year)

65000

Notice period

1 month

Questions about your current salary or a day rate are always left for you.

Education & language

Highest level of education

Bachelor's degree

English level

Native or bilingual

Links

LinkedIn profile URL

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/...>

Website or portfolio

<https://...>

GitHub

<https://github.com/...>

Your name, email and phone number come from the extension popup's settings.

Your own answers

For anything else. If a question contains the words on the left, the answer on the right is used. Answers can be Yes/No, a number, or the text of the option to pick. These are checked first.

If the question contains

how did you hear

Answer

LinkedIn

×

[+ Add answer](#)

✔ Try a question

Check what Auto Apply would answer, using the answers on this page (including unsaved changes).

e.g. Are you legally authorised to work in the United Kingdom?

Yes / No choice

▼

Application Answers (click **Save answers** after changes)

4. Expand Network

1. Set your **Target Roles** and daily limit in Settings.
2. On LinkedIn, open the popup and click **Expand Network**.
3. The extension searches LinkedIn for each role in turn and, with natural pauses, clicks Connect, types a short personal note and sends it. It moves to the next role after *Connections Per Role* invites.
4. It stops at your daily limit, if LinkedIn shows an invitation-limit warning, or when you click **Stop**.

Leave the LinkedIn tab open while it runs. It pauses 10–30 seconds between invites on purpose, so a run takes a while.

Free LinkedIn accounts can only add a few personalised notes a month; when LinkedIn blocks the note, the invite is sent without one.

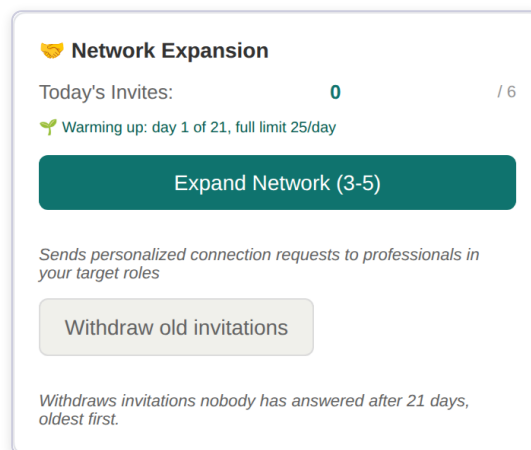
Built-in safety

- **Warm-up:** a new account starts at a quarter of your daily limit, rising to the full limit over 3 weeks. The popup shows 🌱 *Warming up: day 4 of 21* while it lasts.
- **Nobody is invited twice**, even if an earlier invitation was withdrawn or they appear under several roles.
- **Do not contact:** people, companies (e.g. your current employer) or profile links in this Settings list are always skipped. The 🚫 button on the Analytics page adds someone.
- **Profile first:** each person's profile is viewed for a few seconds in a background tab before inviting, as a person would.

4. Expand Network (continued)

Withdraw old invitations

LinkedIn limits how many invitations can wait unanswered, and a large backlog counts against you. Click **Withdraw old invitations** in the popup (every week or two): JobTrail opens your sent invitations, withdraws the ones older than 21 days (change this in Settings), oldest first, and marks them *Withdrawn* on the Analytics page. LinkedIn won't let you re-invite those people for about 3 weeks, and JobTrail won't invite them again anyway.



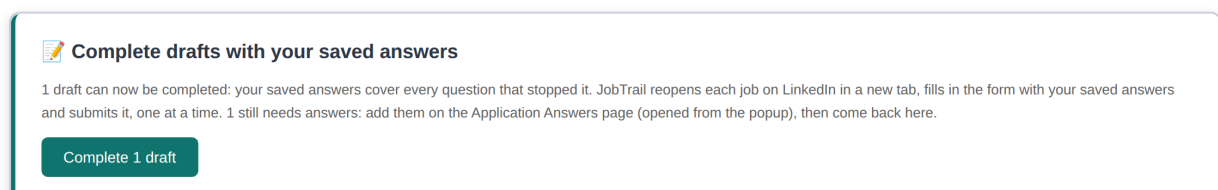
Network Expansion in the popup, with the warm-up and withdraw button

5. Auto Apply to jobs

1. Set **Target Job Roles**, work types and salary in Settings, and fill in **Application Answers**.
2. Click **Auto Apply to Jobs**. The extension searches Easy Apply jobs, checks each title against your roles, fills in each page of the form from your saved answers and submits.
3. Applications it can't finish are saved as drafts (LinkedIn keeps its own copy too) and listed on the Applications page as *Needs completion*.

Completing drafts

Answer the waiting questions on the Application Answers page. Drafts whose questions all have answers now show ✓ *Answers saved*, and the popup shows (*1 draft ready*). Click **Complete drafts** on the Applications page (or **Complete them now** on the Answers page, or ► **Auto-complete** on one row): a LinkedIn tab opens each job in turn, fills in the form and submits it. Anything that still asks a new question stays a draft, with the new question added to the list.



Drafts ready to complete on the Applications page

Review your Application Answers before your first run. Every answer it gives comes from what you entered, so check they're accurate.

6. Tracking your applications

- **Status:** change it from the dropdown in the table (Applied → Interviewing → Offer / Rejected / Withdrawn).
- **Timeline:** opens the history for an application, where you can add dated notes and set a follow-up reminder date.
- **Follow-ups due:** lists applications with no update after the number of days you choose (default 7). Click **Followed up** after chasing, or **Snooze 3 days**.
- **+ Add:** track an application you made outside LinkedIn.
- **What's working:** interview rates by role and by work type.
- **Export / Import CSV:** keep a spreadsheet copy or move to another computer.

Job Applications Tracker

Track every application from submission to offer, and know when to follow up

TOTAL APPLICATIONS

5

AWAITING REPLY

2

INTERVIEWING

1

OFFERS

0

NEEDS COMPLETION

2

FOLLOW-UPS DUE

1

Follow-ups due

Remind me after days without an update

Security Engineer at Acme Security
Applied, no update for 10 days

View job

✓ Followed up

Snooze 3 days

Timeline

Complete drafts with your saved answers

1 draft can now be completed: your saved answers cover every question that stopped it. JobTrail reopens each job on LinkedIn in a new tab, fills in the form with your saved answers and submits it, one at a time. 1 still needs answers: add them on the Application Answers page (opened from the popup), then come back here.

Complete 1 draft

Search job titles or companies...

All Statuses

All Work Types

+ Add

Refresh

Import CSV

Export CSV

Job Title	Company	Work Type	Salary	Location	Applied	Last Update	Status	Actions
Information Security Officer	Harbour Trust	HYBRID	--	Canterbury	26 Sept	today	Needs completion	Auto-complete ✓ Answers saved Timeline Open job Delete
Cloud Security Engineer	Brightline	REMOTE	--	Remote	25 Sept	yesterday	Needs completion	Auto-complete Needs 1 answer Timeline Open job Delete
IT Manager	Penfold Ltd	ONSITE	--	Maidstone	24 Sept	2d ago	Applied	Timeline View Job Delete
GRC Analyst	Northbank plc	REMOTE	--	United Kingdom	22 Sept	yesterday	Interviewing	Timeline Delete
22 Sept 2026 Applied 25 Sept 2026 Status: Interviewing 25 Sept 2026 Phone screen booked for Tuesday Add a note (e.g. phone screen with Sarah, next round Tuesday) Add note Remind me to follow up on mm/dd/yyyy								
Security Engineer	Acme Security	HYBRID	£60,000-£70,000	London	16 Sept	10d ago	Applied	Timeline View Job Delete

What's working

From 3 submitted applications: 1 reached interview. Update each application's status as you hear back to keep this accurate. (Small numbers, so treat the rates as a rough guide.)

By target role

Role	Applied	Heard Back	Interviews	Offers	Interview Rate
GRC Analyst	1	1	1	0	100%
IT Manager	1	0	0	0	0%
Security Engineer	1	0	0	0	0%

By work type

Work Type	Applied	Heard Back	Interviews	Offers	Interview Rate
Hybrid	1	0	0	0	0%
On-site	1	0	0	0	0%
Remote	1	1	1	0	100%

Applications tracker with a timeline opened

7. Connection analytics and welcome messages

The Analytics page shows how many invitations were sent, accepted and declined, and which roles and times work best.

- **Check Accepted Connections** (bottom of the page) visits your sent invitations and connections on LinkedIn to update who has accepted.
- **Welcome messages:** a day (adjustable) after someone accepts, a friendly message is suggested. Edit it if you like, then click **Send via LinkedIn**: a LinkedIn tab opens, the message is typed and sent, and the tab closes. **New wording** gives an alternative; **Skip** removes it from the list.

For safety, a welcome message is only sent if the conversation that opens is with that exact person. If two of your connections share the name, it asks you to message them yourself.

Message test (which wording works better?)

In **Message test** on the Analytics page, write two versions of your invitation note (use `{first}`, `{role}` and `{field}` for their first name, job title and area of work), choose **Test A against B** and save. Each invitation then uses one at random, and the table shows how many of each were accepted. Once each has 20 or more invitations it tells you if one is clearly better, and offers **Use wording A/B from now on**.

 **Message test**

Write two wordings for your invitation note. While the test is on, each invitation uses one of them at random, and the results below show which gets more acceptances. Use `{first}` for their first name, `{role}` for their job title and `{field}` for their area of work. Keep each under 200 characters: LinkedIn cuts longer notes on some free accounts.

☐ Off (use the built-in wordings) ☒ Test A against B ☐ Always use A ☐ Always use B

Wording A

Hi {first}, I'm exploring my next move in {field} and would value connecting with people in {role} roles.

About 136 characters once filled in

Save message test

Wording B

Hello {first}, your work as {role} caught my eye. I am looking for new opportunities in {field} and would love to connect.

About 153 characters once filled in

Wording	Sent	Accepted	Acceptance rate
A	3	1	33%
B	2	1	50%

Too early to tell: aim for at least 20 invitations with each wording (so far A 3, B 2).

Message test on the Analytics page

Connection Analytics

Track your networking performance

5
TOTAL SENT

2
ACCEPTED

2
PENDING

1
DECLINED

0
WITHDRAWN

40%
ACCEPTANCE RATE

0h
AVG RESPONSE TIME

Welcome messages

Suggest a message day(s) after someone accepts

2 ready to send. Check or edit each message, then send it; it's typed into LinkedIn for you in a new tab. Use "Check Accepted Connections" below to find new acceptances.

Sarah Khan - found via "GRC" - accepted today

Hi Sarah, thanks for connecting! I'm currently looking for IT Manager or Security Engineer roles and it's great to be connected with people in cybersecurity. If you ever hear of an opening that might suit, I'd really appreciate a heads-up. Hope you have a great week.

Send via LinkedIn

New wording

Skip

James Reid - found via "IT Manager" - accepted today

Hi James, thanks for connecting. I'm actively looking for IT Manager or Security Engineer roles in the UK and always happy to swap notes with others in IT. If there's ever anything I can help with in return, just let me know.

Send via LinkedIn

New wording

Skip

Message test

Write two wordings for your invitation note. While the test is on, each invitation uses one of them at random, and the results below show which gets more acceptances. Use `{first}` for their first name, `{role}` for their job title and `{field}` for their area of work. Keep each under 200 characters. LinkedIn cuts longer notes on some free accounts.

☐ Off (use the built-in wordings) ☒ Test A against B ☐ Always use A ☐ Always use B

Wording A

Hi {first}, I'm exploring my next move in {field} and would value connecting with people in {role} roles.

About 136 characters once filled in

Save message test

Wording	Sent	Accepted	Acceptance rate
A	3	1	33%
B	2	1	50%

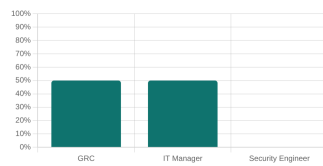
Too early to tell: aim for at least 20 invitations with each wording (so far A 3, B 2).

Wording B

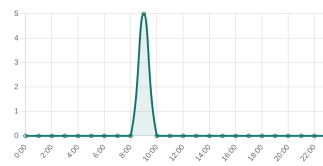
Hello {first}, your work as {role} caught my eye. I am looking for new opportunities in {field} and would love to connect.

About 153 characters once filled in

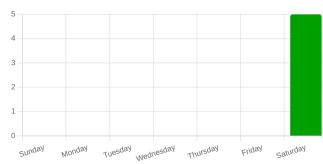
Acceptance Rate by Role



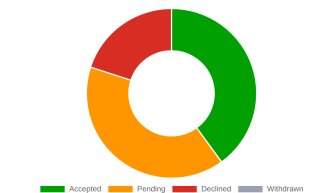
Requests by Time of Day



Requests by Day of Week



Status Distribution



Recent Connection Requests

Name	Role	Sent Date	Status	Response Time	Time of Day	Welcome
Emma Wood	GRC	9/26/2026 09:42 AM	Declined	< 1h	9:00 AM	Don't contact
Tom Hughes	IT Manager	9/26/2026 09:42 AM	Pending	--	9:00 AM	Don't contact
Priya Patel	Security Engineer	9/26/2026 09:42 AM	Pending	--	9:00 AM	Don't contact
James Reid	IT Manager	9/26/2026 09:42 AM	Accepted	< 1h	9:00 AM	To do Don't contact
Sarah Khan	GRC	9/26/2026 09:42 AM	Accepted	< 1h	9:00 AM	To do Don't contact

Export to CSV

Import from CSV

Refresh Data

Check Accepted Connections

Recalculate Stats

Reset Accepted to Pending

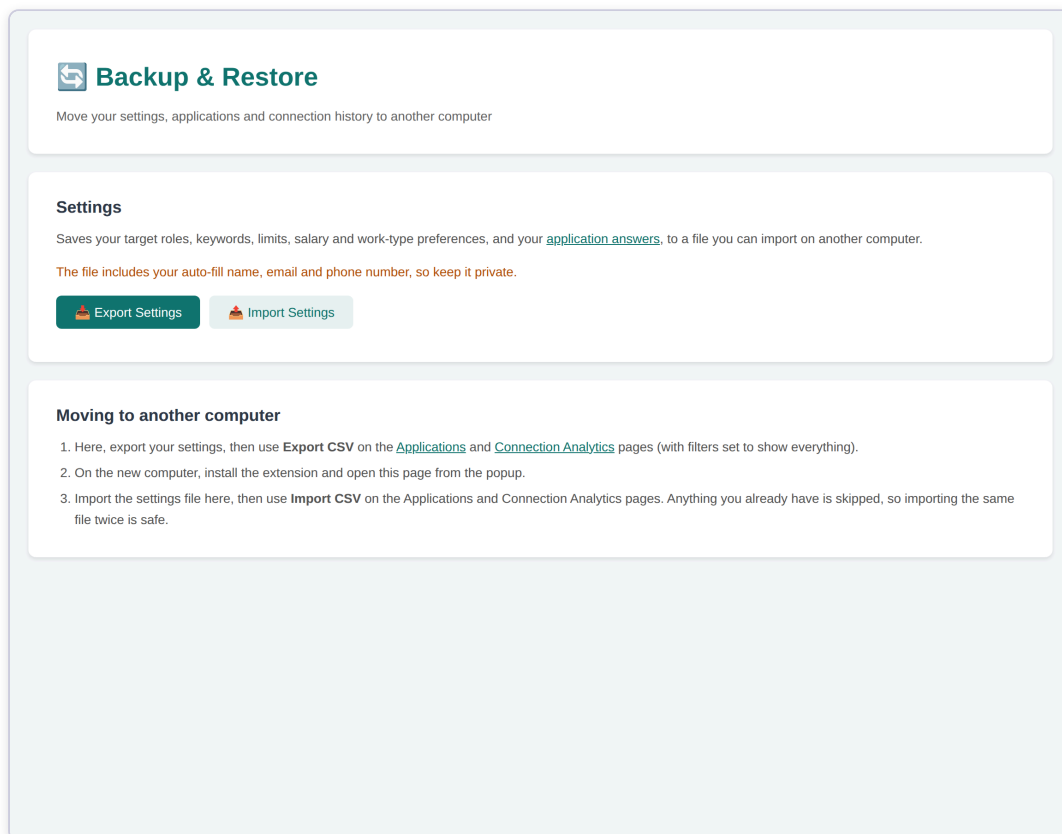
Connection analytics with the welcome-message queue

8. Backup & Restore (moving to another computer)

1. On the old computer: open **Backup & Restore** from the popup and click **Export Settings**. Then click **Export CSV** on the Applications and Analytics pages (with filters set to show everything).
2. On the new computer: install the extension, open Backup & Restore and **Import Settings**, then **Import CSV** on the Applications and Analytics pages.

Importing the same file twice is safe; anything already there is skipped. Automation stays switched off after importing until you start it.

The settings file contains your name, email and phone number. Keep it private.



Backup & Restore

9. Staying safe on LinkedIn

Important: LinkedIn's User Agreement does not permit automated tools. Using any automation carries a risk of warnings or restrictions on your account. You use JobTrail's automation at your own risk (see the Terms of Use).

- Keep daily limits low: around 20–30 invitations and 10–20 applications a day. Don't raise them to catch up.
- Don't run it all day. A session or two a day looks more natural.
- If LinkedIn shows a warning, a CAPTCHA or an invitation-limit message, stop for a few days.
- Keep your acceptance rate healthy by targeting relevant roles; many ignored invitations can trigger limits. Withdraw old invitations every week or two.
- Leave **Warm up gradually** on for a new account or after a break of a few weeks.
- Check your Application Answers are true. You're responsible for what is submitted.

10. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Buttons in the popup are greyed out	Click Review & accept in the popup and accept the Terms of Use.
Buttons in the popup do nothing	Reload the LinkedIn tab (the extension starts when the page loads), then try again.
"Found 0 Connect buttons"	LinkedIn may have changed its page. Turn on Show detailed logs in Settings and reload LinkedIn. Press F12 → Console, filter by <code>Network Expander</code> , and send the lines (especially <i>Page summary</i>) to support.
Many applications end up as drafts	Open Application Answers and answer the <i>Questions waiting</i> .
Settings didn't stick	Click Save Settings / Save answers before closing.
Nothing happens after updating	Click ↻ on the extension in <code>chrome://extensions</code> , then reload LinkedIn.